DANIEL ACHKAR

Game Designer & Programmer

Abu Dhabi, UAE | +971 56 699 7334 | danielachkar2@gmail.com | github.com/Danozix021

PROFILE

Games programming student at SAE University College Dubai with a strong focus on game design: systems, narrative and playtesting, backed by hands-on Unity/C# programming. Seeking a game design or gameplay internship.

EDUCATION

SAE University College Dubai — Bachelor of Games Development, Games Programming — Sep 2023 – Expected May 2027

York University, Toronto — Undeclared Major (transferred, no credits carried over) — 2022 – 2023

Yasmina Academy, Abu Dhabi — A Levels: Mathematics, Biology, Business — 2020 – 2022

PROJECTS

Witch Doctor — Game Designer & Programmer | Unity, C# | Team of 4, 13 weeks — ▶ See in portfolio

Physics-based first-person game where you diagnose patients and brew cures from processed ingredients.

- Designed the game's main systems, including the ingredient processing types, 9 illnesses and 8 ingredients.
- Wrote most of the project documentation, including the full Game Design Document and market research.
- Ran 3 rounds of playtesting with 10+ testers and analysed the results, turning findings into shipped fixes.
- Designed and programmed the shop system from scratch in C#, including its UI, cart and transaction logic.

Cartography of Silence — Game Designer | Unity | Team of 3, 7 weeks (prototype) — ▶ See in portfolio

Narrative shop sim where you sell hand-marked maps to travellers, inspired by Papers, Please.

- Sole designer: designed the core loop, in which NPCs request a destination and the player marks it on a map and hands it over, plus the faction, consequence and ending systems.
- Designed a branching moral-choice system for the full game, in which helping one faction (e.g. misleading hunters for starving goblins) changes later encounters.

Autonomous NPC AI — Solo | Unity, C# | 8 weeks — ▶ See in portfolio

Grid-based A pathfinding with sense-driven NPC decision-making.*

- Implemented a simple grid-based version of A* pathfinding in C#, with an on-screen debug view of path length and waypoints.
- Built a modular NPC AI where a vision cone (with wall line-of-sight checks) and hearing drive a priority state machine (Collect, Investigate, Patrol), reused on a second NPC through Inspector settings only.

A Tale of Battle — Game Designer | Tabletop | Team of 2, 4 weeks (completed) — ▶ See in portfolio

1v1 hidden-information strategy board game.

- Designed the game and wrote the full rulebook: players secretly deploy warriors across 3 lanes, then reveal and resolve combat, taking damage through undefended lanes.
- Designed a between-round shop phase where players buy warriors and equipment to build their deck.

SKILLS

Design	Rulebooks, playtesting, systems, economy & narrative design, tabletop
Engines	Unity, Unreal Engine (asset integration)
Languages	C#
Systems	Gameplay systems, AI (A*, state machines), UI, Unity Input System
Tools	Blender, Krita, Trello

EXTRAS

- **Languages:** English (fluent), Arabic (native), French (well versed)
- **Community work:** One-week volunteer trip to Uganda helping to build a school (2020)